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Q2

a)

Cultural ecology is the study of relationship between man and environment, and the impact of ecological adaptation on humans.

Julian Steward a neo-evolutionist highlighted the importance of environment in evolutionary study.

History Emerged as reaction to the ~~unitarian~~ universal evolution of culture and negligence of environment factor by V. Gordon Childe and Leslie White. Also, Steward was opposed to psychic unity of early classical evolutionist.

Premises Julian Steward through his cultural ecology model

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highlighted the 'multilinear' evolution theory :- According to it culture evolution took place in different parallel evolutionary lines with adapting effect of environment.

Approach he highlighted the need of human in exploiting resources which led to

↓
development of technology and tools to harness resources

↓
established relation between people and technology

↓
technology related to economy

↓
thus people and economic system ties

↓
economic systems is combined

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influence of policy, religion, social
phenomena

↓
thus, economic system forms core
of culture. related to efficiency of
technology.

methodology He followed parallelism
and causality principles.

Parallelism - with same environment
and conditions, similar development
of culture.

for example - Five civilisations gone
through same phase -

hunting/
gathering → agriculture → modern
tools societies

Causality - environment and humans
are interacting. Environment is
dynamic and keeps changing.
Thus in order to survive humans

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keep changing technology to survive -

Evaluation

Criticism 1) Ray Rapoport says technology
can't be only factor. for ex Pig feast
in Melanesian society
(Religion as source)

2) Confused history with the evolution.

However, with cultural ecology approach,
introduced in Anthropology the role
of environment and its study
with human behaviour which
helped in studies humans as
part of environment.